Boston Sunday Globe

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November 30, 2025

MAHA sees opportunity in $50b rural hospital fund

States have incentive to follow group's priorities

By Tal Kopan
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — When President Trump's signature tax and spending cuts legislation was on the ropes earlier this year, senators added a $50 billion fund intended to soften the blow to rural hospitals and appease holdouts, allowing the One Big Beautiful Bill to narrowly pass with only Republican votes.

Although they welcomed the relief, even supporters acknowledged the money would not be enough to completely compensate for the breadth of cuts coming to Medicaid.

But the Trump administration saw another opportunity: using the fund to push states to adopt its "Make America Healthy Again," or MAHA, policies. Funding requirements rolled out by the Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services, or CMS, reward states that include MAHA priorities, such as promoting more nutrition in medical care and restricting food stamp purchases. While many are broadly in line with the goals of health care providers, the

MAHA, Page A11

Who employs the most SNAP recipients?

In Mass., 74 percent of working-age people on food stamps have jobs

By Katie Johnston
GLOBE STAFF

People who rely on government assistance are often subject to the same three-word admonishment: Get a job.

But many already have one.

In Massachusetts, 74 percent of working-age recipients of the Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program are employed, half of them full time.

At a time when the food-stamp system is under fire and more strict work requirements are starting to kick in, a Globe review of companies with the most SNAP recipients in the state shows many are employed by high-profile companies in retail, health care, and the gig economy.

SNAP, Page A12

ICE MOVES QUICKLY — AND RAISES CONCERNS

ERIN CLARK/GLOBE STAFF

João Marciano do Carmo returned to his mother, Ana Geralda do Carmo (left), and the rest of his family after being held out of state.

Advocates say immigrants' rights are lost amid speedy removal from home

By Marcela Rodrigues and Scooty Nickerson | Globe Staff

MILFORD — In mid-November, João Marciano do Carmo returned to his family in Milford, embraced his crying mother, and fell into the comfort of his living room couch. The 19-year-old had finally made the journey home from a jail in Mississippi, one of the detention facilities where he had been held since September on an immigration-related violation that, lawyers say, never warranted his detention in the first place.

He's not alone, according to a Globe analysis of arrest and detention data and interviews with immigration attorneys and experts. Immigrants in New England targeted for deportation are being whisked away quicker and to farther locations than ever before. They are increasingly brought to remote areas of the country where they face more conservative judges who are less likely to grant them freedom, according to the interviews and the data analysis.

> ICE arrests in the Boston area more than **tripled** in the first seven months of this year compared to last, while the number of people sent to facilities outside New England **spiked sixfold**, according to a Globe analysis.

As agents carry out that agenda, advocates and legal analysts say, immigrants have lost essential due process rights. Detainees legally eligible for bond are moved quickly, and at times in violation of court orders. It can take days for them to be able to call their families. Often, not even their lawyers know where they are.

Legal experts warn the rapid rise in transfers to far-flung states is likely to accelerate as billions of dollars allocated by Congress in the One Big Beautiful Bill Act last summer begin to flow to detention centers.

"To be super clear, this is the beginning," said Kathleen Bush-Joseph, an attorney and policy analyst at the Migration Policy Institute. "They are ramping up, but they have plans to go so much bigger."

Tricia McLaughlin, assistant secretary at the Department of Homeland Security, said in a statement Tuesday that detainees do receive due process and are provided "ample opportunity" to communicate with attorneys and family members. McLaughlin said ICE makes transfer decisions based on bed space.

"No lawbreakers in the history of human civilization have been

ICE, Page A12

Freeport, Maine, has more to offer than L.L. Bean and outlet stores. **SundayTravel, N11.**

This was a week for family feasts, but are dining rooms a thing of the past? **Address, H1.**

The Globe Magazine is not publishing today. Puzzles are on **B4.**

A story of giving

Globe Santa has been bringing gifts and cheer to children for 70 years. **Metro, B1.**

VOL. 308, NO. 153

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Suggested retail price
$6.00

Glove-ly weather

Sunday: Cloudy. High: 47-52. Low: 35-40.
Monday: Some sun. High: 42-47. Low: 24-29.
Sunrise: 6:53 Sunset: 4:13
Complete report, **C22.** Deaths, **C16-20.**

'The knowledge we don't uncover stays hidden.'

NATHAN GRAWE, *education economist at Carleton College in Minnesota, about PhD research*

New England schools enrolling fewer new PhDs

By Diti Kohli
GLOBE STAFF

Casey Grippo thought there was more time.

Typically, the philosophy department at Boston University funds PhD candidates for up to seven years. Grippo, who uses they/them pronouns, started PhD coursework in 2020, and as of September, still had a dissertation to finish and undergraduate writing classes to teach before graduating, likely in spring 2027.

That was until a few weeks ago, when Grippo was told they were expected to graduate this coming May — a consequence of BU's decision to tighten funding for PhDs beyond their fifth year.

"There was suddenly a hard line that no post-fifth-year PhDs should be eligible" for university funding or teaching opportunities on campus, Grippo said. "If I knew that I was meaningfully going to have five years to finish my PhD earlier on, I would've done a lot of things differently."

A similar feeling is being felt in doctoral programs all over New England. In a dramatic and

DEGREES, Page A13

JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

Casey Grippo, a sixth-year PhD student at Boston University, is in the final stages of finishing their philosophy dissertation.